



North Korea did Wannacry?

The U.S. government has officially blamed North Korea for WannaCry, the ransomware that spread across the world <http://dgit.in/NKWCry>



Interspecies intercourse

Adolescent female Japanese macaques are apparently indulging in sexual activities with male sika deer. <http://dgit.in/MnkyXDeer>



MARVIN THE PARANOID ANDROID

Marvin from *The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy* has an existential crisis of his own. Marvin can compose songs to make babies fall asleep, while successfully solving all the problems in the universe multiple times. Marvin is continuously miserable and bored. The problem is that he was designed to mimic human thought. The technology is known as "Genuine People Personalities." Marvin's irreparable condition is an example of what can go wrong if we try and make robots more like humans. While we're at it, you now know why Mithun calls his column that, and why he's always in a bad mood!

DROIDS FROM STAR WARS

The Star Wars Droids are perhaps the best example of intelligence in science fiction. Despite being set in a galaxy with sophisticated technology, the droids are not hyper connected or superintelligent – they're just fun! Still, BB-8 and R2D2 show plenty of initiative, and are extremely loyal, bailing out their owners from a number of tricky situations. Both droids have shown the ability to successfully interface with, and takeover a number of other technologies, including doors, spaceships, other droids, and walking tanks. They could use the ability to do a cloud backup though!



CORTANA

Cortana is an example of an AI that has made the jump from fiction to reality – with vastly reduced capabilities. The hologram appearance of Cortana shows that there is no need for a physical embodiment of an AI. In the Halo series, it is assumed that all smart AI eventually develop psychological problems, because of the power and intelligence they accumulate. Because of this, over-mart beings such as Cortana have an enforced seven year life span. Cortana manages to escape into a strange universal database called The Domain, which allows her to live indefinitely. A truly interesting take to have expiry dates on AI.



HELIOS

Helios from Deus Ex explores several implications of humans interacting with artificial intelligences. If one AI is allowed to interface with another AI, will they combine to form a single, even more capable AI? In Deus Ex, a good and bad AI accidentally merge into one during a routine operation. The resulting AI, Helios, suggests the next step in human evolution is to merge the human brain with the AI. A step beyond direct man-machine interfaces, is linking all human brains to one another, as well as to machines, thus allowing a human element to persist as a singularity – the ultimate superintelligence.

THE EAGLE

The Eagle from Arthur C Clarke's *Rama* series is perhaps the most versatile example of an AI construct. The Eagle is a biological construct, but is still an AI. It's mesmerising to look at, half man, half eagle, with beautiful blue feathers. It has vocal chords to speak to humans, but also has a specialised structure to allow it to speak to an alien species that communicates through colours. It's an interesting concept to have a swiss army knife approach to AI, where the design is dynamically generated to serve the needs of the moment.



GLADOS

GLaDOS, short for Genetic Lifeform and Disk Operating System is an AI from the game *Portal*, known for her crushing psychological manipulation, as well as her beautiful voice. She is killed by the protagonist, Chell, after GLaDOS keeps gaslighting Chell throughout the duration of the game, predicting dire scenarios in a clinically disinterested voice. At the end of *Portal*, one can't help but feel sorry for killing the AI, despite all the evil acts GLaDOS has done. This guilt is assuaged by GLaDOS declaring that she is still alive, in a song that is very different from the musical works of Marvin the Paranoid Android.